

TEQSA Provider: PRV14085 CRICOS Code: 03705J

Critical Incident Management Policy

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Policy is to establish the governance framework through which The Institute of International Studies (TIIS) prepares for, responds to, manages, and reviews critical incidents that may affect students, staff, visitors, institutional operations, reputation, assets, or regulatory compliance.

TIIS is committed to ensuring the safety and wellbeing of its students and staff, maintaining operational continuity, complying with regulatory obligations, and supporting effective decision-making during and following critical incidents. This Policy supports compliance with the Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021, the Education Services for Overseas Students Act 2000, the National Code 2018, and relevant work health and safety legislation.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to:

- all students, including international students;
- staff, contractors, volunteers, and visitors;
- all TIIS campuses, facilities, and activities;
- online learning environments and information systems;
- offshore, transnational, and third-party delivery arrangements undertaken on behalf of TIIS.

This Policy applies to incidents occurring on or off campus where the incident may impact the welfare of students or staff, the reputation of TIIS, or the Institute's ability to fulfil its educational and regulatory obligations.

3. Policy Statement

TIIS recognises that critical incidents may arise unexpectedly and require a coordinated, timely, and effective institutional response.

The Institute is committed to:

- prioritising the safety, health, and wellbeing of affected individuals;
- responding promptly and effectively to critical incidents;
- ensuring clear leadership, accountability, and communication during incidents;
- maintaining business continuity wherever possible;
- complying with all reporting and regulatory obligations;
- providing appropriate support services to affected individuals;

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- learning from incidents through review and continuous improvement processes.

The Board of Directors expects that all critical incidents will be managed in accordance with approved procedures and that appropriate governance oversight will be maintained throughout the incident lifecycle.

4. Definition of a Critical Incident

For the purposes of this Policy, a critical incident is any actual, suspected, or threatened event that causes, or has the potential to cause:

- serious injury, illness, trauma, or death;
- significant disruption to academic or business operations;
- substantial damage to property, systems, or infrastructure;
- significant reputational harm;
- regulatory or legal consequences;
- threats to the safety or wellbeing of students, staff, or visitors.

Examples of critical incidents may include serious accidents, natural disasters, public health emergencies, acts of violence, sexual assault, cyber incidents, major information security breaches, or any event requiring an emergency institutional response.

5. Critical Incident Management Framework

TIIS will maintain a Critical Incident Management Procedure that establishes operational processes for:

- incident identification and reporting;
- emergency response and escalation;
- activation of a Critical Incident Management Team;
- stakeholder communication;
- student and staff support;
- regulatory notifications;
- recovery and business continuity activities;
- post-incident review and reporting.

The Chief Executive Officer is responsible for ensuring that appropriate procedures, resources, and response capabilities are maintained and regularly tested.

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6. Student and Staff Support

TIIS is committed to supporting individuals affected by critical incidents.

Appropriate support measures may include:

- welfare and wellbeing support;
- counselling services;
- academic support arrangements;
- reasonable adjustments to study or work requirements;
- referral to external support services where appropriate.

Additional support will be provided to international students where required, including liaison with family members, guardians, sponsors, government agencies, and overseas representatives.

7. Communication and Reporting

TIIS will ensure that communication during a critical incident is accurate, timely, coordinated, and appropriate to the circumstances.

Only authorised personnel may communicate with the media or make public statements on behalf of the Institute.

Where required by legislation or regulatory obligations, TIIS will notify relevant authorities, including TEQSA, the Department of Education, the Department of Home Affairs, emergency services, insurers, and other agencies as appropriate.

8. Governance and Accountability

Board of Directors

The Board of Directors is responsible for:

- approving the Critical Incident Management Policy;
- overseeing institutional preparedness and risk management;
- monitoring significant critical incidents;
- reviewing reports relating to major incidents and corrective actions.

Chief Executive Officer

The Chief Executive Officer is responsible for:

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- overall institutional leadership during critical incidents;
- activating emergency response arrangements;
- ensuring compliance with reporting obligations;
- reporting significant incidents to the Board.

Executive Management Team

The Executive Management Team is responsible for coordinating institutional responses, supporting recovery activities, and implementing corrective actions arising from incident reviews.

Staff Members

All staff members are responsible for promptly reporting actual or suspected critical incidents and complying with the Critical Incident Management Procedure.

9. Post-Incident Review and Continuous Improvement

Following the resolution of a critical incident, TIIS will undertake a formal review to evaluate the effectiveness of the response, identify lessons learned, and determine opportunities for improvement.

The outcomes of significant incident reviews will be reported to the Executive Management Team and, where appropriate, the Board of Directors.

Recommendations arising from reviews will be incorporated into relevant policies, procedures, training programs, risk management activities, and business continuity planning processes.

10. Related Documents

This Policy should be read in conjunction with:

- Critical Incident Management Procedure;
- Risk Management Policy;
- Crisis Management Plan;
- Business Continuity Plan;
- Work Health and Safety Policy;
- Student Support and Wellbeing Policy;
- Sexual Harm Prevention and Response Policy;
- Data and Cybersecurity Policy;

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- Records Management Policy.

11. Legislative and Regulatory Framework

This Policy is informed by:

- Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021;
- Education Services for Overseas Students Act 2000;
- National Code of Practice for Providers of Education and Training to Overseas Students 2018;
- Work Health and Safety Act 2011;
- Privacy Act 1988;
- Relevant state and Commonwealth emergency management legislation.

12. Policy Review

Version:	2.0 Draft
Policy Category	Governance – Risk, Safety, and Compliance
Approved by:	Executive Management Team (EMT)
Endorsement Body	Board of Directors
Authored by	CEO/Registrar
HESF	Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021
Creation Date	29 July 2025
Approval Body	Board of Directors
Approval Date:	29 May 2026
Duration:	3 Years from Approval Date

*****END OF POLICY and PROCEDURE*****

